

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Microsoft Sentinel | Defender XDR | Detection Engineering | Incident Response

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Analyst and Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience in Security Operations Centre (SOC) analysis, Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) detection engineering, and incident response. I specialise in Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), with strong proficiency in KQL query development, analytics rule authoring, and MITRE ATT&CK framework-aligned detection content. I have a demonstrated track record of conducting advanced investigations escalated from managed detection and response (MDR) SOC providers, leading the full incident lifecycle from detection through to lessons learned, and developing KQL-based analytics rules to expand MITRE ATT&CK coverage. I am experienced in mentoring junior analysts and fostering a culture of continuous improvement within security operations teams.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL development, analytics rules, workbooks, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detections, data connectors, Logic Apps playbooks)
- **Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** Microsoft Defender XDR, Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Defender for Office 365
- **EDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, CrowdStrike Insight threat hunting
- **Incident Response:** Full lifecycle IR (NIST 800-61): detection, analysis, containment, eradication, recovery, lessons learned; playbook and runbook authoring
- **Threat Hunting:** MITRE ATT&CK framework TTPs, proactive hunting across SIEM and EDR platforms
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Sentinel playbooks, Logic Apps, PowerShell automation
- **Threat Intelligence:** Indicator of Compromise (IOC) analysis, threat actor TTP profiling
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Identity Security:** Azure Entra ID, Conditional Access, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), BeyondTrust PAM
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST 800-61, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Conduct advanced threat investigations escalated from Managed Detection and Response (MDR) SOC partners and internally identified threats, including root cause analysis, evidence gathering, containment, and remediation across Microsoft Sentinel and Defender XDR
- Author and deploy KQL-based analytics rules in Microsoft Sentinel, systematically expanding MITRE ATT&CK framework coverage across cloud, identity, endpoint, and network telemetry sources
- Lead incident response through the full lifecycle: detection, analysis, containment, eradication, recovery, and lessons learned (NIST 800-61); develop and maintain IR playbooks and SOC runbooks
- Conduct proactive threat hunting using MITRE ATT&CK TTPs and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight to identify adversary activity prior to automated detection triggering
- Develop SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel using Logic Apps and PowerShell, streamlining alert triage, enrichment, and response workflows
- Mentor junior analysts on KQL development, threat analysis techniques, and incident response methodology; deliver structured knowledge transfer sessions

- Design and maintain Sentinel workbooks, dashboards, and executive reporting to communicate security posture and incident trends to leadership

University of the Arts London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 – March 2025

- Monitored and triaged security alerts from managed Security Operations Centre (SOC) provider and internal tooling using Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, conducting in-depth investigation and escalation
- Developed KQL queries and contributed to the Sentinel analytics rule library, reducing false positive rates and improving detection fidelity across key threat scenarios
- Participated in incident response activities including triage, containment, forensic evidence preservation, and post-incident review; contributed to lessons learned documentation
- Supported development of incident response playbooks and SOC standard operating procedures (SOPs)
- Contributed to vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io and AppCheck; analysed findings and supported prioritised remediation
- Assisted in configuring Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and identity protection policies in Entra ID

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 – March 2022

- Monitored security events and alerts across infrastructure, supporting incident detection and response in a SaaS/FinTech environment
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and coordinated remediation of identified security weaknesses
- Implemented and maintained security policies, access controls, and endpoint protection across the organisation

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built Microsoft Sentinel workspace from zero to operational SOC integration, deploying 15+ data connectors, authoring 30+ analytics rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, and creating SOAR playbooks that reduced phishing alert triage time from 45 minutes to under 5 minutes
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM alongside Microsoft Sentinel, delivering unified SOC visibility across cloud, endpoint, and network telemetry for an 8,000-user estate
- Developed MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection content in Sentinel covering 25+ tactics and techniques, measurably improving detection coverage and reducing dwell time
- Led response to multiple high-priority security incidents including ransomware containment, business email compromise, and insider threat investigations, achieving successful containment and recovery in each case
- Established CrowdStrike Falcon Insight threat hunting programme, proactively identifying and neutralising three latent threats before automated detection would have triggered

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate